Glow Swarm - How to Play

Goal

Survive 10 minutes against an endless neon swarm and destroy both Hive Hearts: the first arrives at 5:00, the second at 10:00. Beat the second one to clear the swarm.

Controls

Phone: touch and drag anywhere to move. A joystick appears under your thumb. You never aim or shoot: your weapons fire on their own.

Desktop: WASD or arrow keys to move, P or Esc to pause, 1/2/3 to pick an upgrade.

The II button at the top right pauses and shows your loadout.

Leveling up

Defeated enemies drop glowing gems. Collect them to fill the XP bar. Each level you pick 1 of 3 cards: a new weapon, a weapon level, or a passive. You can hold up to 4 weapons and 4 passives.

Weapons

Pulse Bolt shoots the nearest enemy. **Halo Orbs** circle you. **Shock Nova** blasts a ring around you. **Prism Lance** fires a piercing beam where you are facing. **Spark Mines** drop exploding mines.

Passives

Focus Lens (faster cooldowns), Wide Field (bigger area), Amplifier (more damage), Glide Boots (speed), Vital Core (max HP and regen), Lure Coil (bigger gem pickup range).

Evolutions

Get a weapon to level 6 while owning its paired passive and a gold EVOLVE card appears: Pulse Bolt + Focus Lens = Cascade Storm; Halo Orbs + Wide Field = Eclipse Ring; Shock Nova + Amplifier = Supernova; Prism Lance + Glide Boots = Spectrum Ray; Spark Mines + Vital Core = Chain Minefield.

Enemies

Purple drones (basic), pink brutes (slow, tough), yellow darts (fast, fragile). Every minute a Swarm Surge hits. A red arrow at the screen edge points to an off-screen Hive Heart.

Shards and the shop

Every run pays shards based on time, kills and bosses beaten. Spend them in the Shard Shop on permanent upgrades: Hull Plating, Overcharge, Thrusters and Resonance (5 levels each). Your best time and kills are saved on your device.

Tips

Keep moving in wide circles so the swarm trails behind you. Grab a passive early, since evolutions win runs. When the screen pulses red you are under 30% HP: break away and let Vital Core regenerate.